

Connecting the Instagram API (publishing + view counts)

This gives Claude **token-based** access: no password, revocable anytime, and it survives between sessions. It's how we measure progress toward the 1M-views goal.

Requirements: each account must be a **Professional** account (Business or Creator). Verify each step against Meta's current docs as we set it up together. Meta renames things often.

Steps (about 20 minutes, done once)

1. Go to developers.facebook.com, log in as yourself, and click **Create App**. Choose the use case for managing Instagram content / "Instagram API with Instagram Login".
2. Add each Instagram account as a tester or connected account, and accept the invite inside Instagram (Settings → Website permissions / Apps).
3. Generate an access token per account with these permissions: `instagram_business_basic`, `instagram_business_content_publish`, `instagram_business_manage_insights`, `instagram_business_manage_comments`.
4. Exchange it for a **long-lived token** (about 60 days, refreshable). Claude can do this step once the short token is stored.
5. Store the tokens in **this cloud environment's settings**, not in chat and not in the repo: session title bar → environment → **Edit** → environment variables: - `IG_TOKEN_MBM` : @minibarnmarket - `IG_TOKEN_FG` : @farmhousegetaways - `IG_TOKEN_FFF` : @financialfreedomfarmgirl
6. Start a new session. Claude will confirm each token works (read-only call first).

What this unlocks

- Pulling views, reach, shares, saves and follows per Reel and Story into `tracking/results.csv`
- Publishing or scheduling Reels and Stories, if you want that. Default: Claude prepares everything and you post, so you can add trending audio in-app.

What it can't do

- Add songs from Instagram's music library (no API for that; add in the app).
- Stickers (polls, questions, links) on Stories: add these in the app.
- The API fetches videos from a public URL, so publishing also needs a place to host the final file (e.g., a Dropbox shared link).